

Keep a small dispute small

Being right can feel so good that we turn a minor disagreement into a costly fight. Keep the dispute the size it actually is.

REMEMBER

- ◆ Righteous anger is a poor adviser.
- ◆ The other person is allowed to care about things you do not.
- ◆ Ask what the dispute is really worth before you decide how hard to fight.

YOUR TURN

A disagreement I am in, or was in recently:

What it is actually about, in one plain sentence:

What it is worth in money, and what fighting it costs in time, energy and reputation:

What the other person cares about here:

The simplest fair way to close it:

THIS WEEK

Choose one open disagreement. Wait a day before you reply, then answer only the actual issue.

Inspired by Michael Schur, "How Ethics Can Help You Make Better Decisions" (TED). General education, not legal advice.